```
user =
  name:
    first: 'Haveno'
    middle: 'Contact'
    last: 'Details'
```

Your program will throw an exception:

```
user.contact.phone.home
# TypeError: cannot read property 'phone' of undefined
```

To avoid this, you *might* wrap the access to the data in a big condition:

```
if user.contact and user.contact.phone and user.contact.phone.home
  user.contact.phone.home
```

Or perhaps you might wrap it in a `try` block:

```
try
  user.contact.phone.home
catch e
  'no contact number'
```

Don't do either. Instead, when rendering information about a user, either display the information or not—don't display an error, `null`, or `undefined`. Use the null soak operator (sometimes called the *safe navigation operator*) to soak `null` values and `undefined` properties so you don't have to test for them explicitly:

```
user?.contact?.phone?.home
```

This will suppress any errors when accessing the user data. An acceptable time to suppress these errors is when rendering data to a user. For example, suppose you have a `render` function that uses a heredoc with interpolation to display the phone number somewhere on a website:

```
render = (user) ->
  """
  <html>
  Home phone for #{user.name.first}: #{user.contact.phone.home}
  """
```